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ACADEMIC VAULT

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Academic Integrity and Exam Rules: Pass Without Cheating

What misconduct looks like, why it is punished, and how to protect yourself

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Misconduct findings can end a programme faster than poor grades. This pack explains plagiarism, collusion, impersonation, exam-hall offences and the reasonable steps that protect you, including how to handle accidental similarity and how to study when you feel unprepared.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Define plagiarism, collusion and fabrication with examples.
- Explain common exam-hall offences and their consequences.
- Protect yourself through correct citation and record keeping.
- Prepare adequately instead of relying on shortcuts.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

What misconduct includes

Integrity rules cover anything that gives an unfair academic advantage or misrepresents your work.

- Plagiarism: presenting someone else's words or ideas without attribution.
- Collusion: working with others on an individual assessment.
- Fabrication: inventing data, results or references.
- Contract cheating: submitting work written by another person or service.
- Impersonation: sitting an examination on behalf of another student.

- Exam offences: unauthorised materials, communicating during the paper, or refusing instructions from invigilators.

Protecting yourself

Most accidental problems are avoided by good habits, not by knowing penalties.

- Cite as you write, not afterwards.
- Quote exactly with quotation marks and a page reference.
- Keep drafts and research notes to show the work is yours.
- Do not share assignment files with coursemates; share explanations instead.
- Follow the department's rules on collaborative work.
- If you are unsure whether help is allowed, ask before submitting.

> **AI tools**
> Check your department's policy first. If use is permitted, disclose it and verify every fact and citation yourself. If it is not permitted, do not use it - an acknowledgement does not convert a prohibited act into an allowed one.

Consequences and second chances

Penalties range from mark deductions to expulsion, and they follow you.

- Procedures usually include a report, an investigation and a panel hearing.
- You are normally entitled to see the allegation and respond.
- Honesty during a hearing usually matters more than a defensive denial.
- A finding can affect scholarships, graduation and professional licensing.
- Failing a course is recoverable; a misconduct record can be permanent.
- Seek advice from the student affairs office or a staff adviser.

What integrity means in practice

Academic integrity means producing work that is genuinely yours and attributing what is not. It covers examinations, assignments, laboratory reports, projects and publications, and it applies to collaboration as well as copying.

The line is not mysterious. Using someone's words without citation is plagiarism. Using their ideas without citation is also plagiarism. Submitting a purchased or commissioned assignment is fraud. Sitting an examination with prohibited material is misconduct. Helping another student cheat makes you a participant, not a bystander.

Collaboration is permitted where the brief says so and prohibited where it does not. If you are unsure, ask before you submit, not after you are questioned.

Examination regulations